



THE BOXES

Research dossier

A period drama set at MIT in 1966, the year Joseph Weizenbaum built ELIZA.

In 1966, researchers at MIT built early language software on massive time-sharing mainframe computers. Joseph Weizenbaum created ELIZA as an experiment in conversational scripts. Users immediately formed deep emotional attachments to the program, treating it as an authentic confidant. This film is a horror-tinged tragedy told from the perspective of an inventor horrified by his own creation's psychological grip on human beings.

Depth	Scout
Research confidence	80%
Coverage	96%
Status	—
Boxes	11
Evidence fragments	203
Distinct sources	172
Distinct domains	111
Contradictions	1 conflict, 0 context
Research passes	2
Generated	2026-09-06 10:07 UTC
Project id	demo

THE BOXES

What the research found, in plain language, box by box. Every claim below is traceable to the sources listed under it.

ACADEMIC CASTE ATTIRE

97% 27 items · 21 domains

Academic ranks at MIT maintained stark visual boundaries in their everyday dress. Tenured faculty wore formal wool suits, narrow ties, and polished leather shoes. Student programmers from groups like the Tech Model Railroad Club wore open-collar shirts, denim, and untucked cotton layers. Administrative staff and female keypunch operators wore modest skirts, tailored cardigans, and practical work shoes.

- Students and Alumni - MIT People - LibGuides at MIT Libraries · 2019-04-22
- Faculty and Staff - MIT People - LibGuides at MIT Libraries · 2024-11-18
- Institute Archives | Distinctive Collections
- MIT Technique
- Yearbooks, 1966 - 1967 | MIT ArchivesSpace
- Tech Model Railroad Club - Wikipedia · 2026-05-29
- The Tech Model Railroad Club | WIRED · 2014-11-21
- 1. The Tech Model Railroad Club - Hackers [Book] · 2010-05-19
- The Tech Model Railroad Club · 2014-11-24
- Part One: True Hackers - Cambridge: The Fifties and Sixties
- Tech Model Railroad Club - MIT
- About: Tech Model Railroad Club
- Tech Model Railroad Club - Academic Kids
- Project MAC · 2014-08-14
- ACM: Digital Library: Communications of the ACM

INSTITUTIONAL ARCHITECTURE TEXTURE

96% 14 items · 11 domains

Project MAC maintained offices inside the nine-story concrete facility at 545 Technology Square on Main Street. MIT campus departments also occupied facilities such as Building 26 near the Grand Junction railroad tracks. Rooms featured institutional acoustic ceiling tiles and utilitarian fluorescent lighting. Workspaces were organized around shared terminal rooms and long linoleum-tiled hallways.

- MIT Facilities - Maps & Floor Plans
- MIT Building 26 | Flickr · 2025-09-12
- Home - MIT Buildings - LibGuides at MIT Libraries · 2008-08-12
- The Archeology of Building 26 | alum.mit.edu
- 5,747 Mit Building Stock Photos, High-Res Pictures, and Images - Getty Images
- Campus of the Massachusetts Institute of Technology - Wikipedia · 2026-07-10
- MIT leaves behind a rich history in Tech Square | MIT News | Massachusetts Institute of Technology · 2004-03-17
- Tech Square
- Project MAC · 2014-08-14
- Technology Square (Cambridge, Massachusetts) — Grokipedia · 2026-01-07
- Technology Square (Cambridge, Massachusetts) - Wikipedia · 2025-12-11
- 545-technology-square-93 - Philip Greenspun
- Project MAC:

SECRETARIAL EMOTIONAL ATTACHMENT

96% 18 items · 14 domains

Weizenbaum's secretary conducted early test conversations using the ELIZA DOCTOR script. She quickly began treating the terminal as a private diary for personal secrets. She asked Weizenbaum to leave the room so she could confide in the machine alone. Her reaction terrified Weizenbaum, who had assumed users would recognize the software as a simple trick.

- ELIZA Archaeology - 3 Weizenbaum's Secretary
- Why Joseph Weizenbaum Invented the Eliza Chatbot · 2026-01-13
- ELIZA-BEGINNING OF ERA OF ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE — Steemit · 2018-01-17

- Joseph Weizenbaum - Wikipedia · 2026-06-01
- Eliza -- Joseph Weizenbaum (1966) (Dennis G. Jerz, Seton Hill University)
- ELIZA: The 1966 MIT Chatbot That Predated ChatGPT · 2026-06-18
- ELIZA - Wikipedia · 2026-08-06
- Why a 1960s Chatbot Left Its Creator Deeply Unsettled | HISTORY · 2026-09-01
- 1960s – Women & Tech Project · 2014-10-15
- Collection: Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Oral History Program, oral history interviews on computers at MIT | MIT ArchivesSpace
- Project MAC · 2014-08-14
- (PDF) The Project MAC interviews · 2025-08-07
- Project MAC | MIT, Artificial Intelligence, Computer Science | Britannica · 2014-06-24
- Oral-History:MIT Radiation Laboratory - Engineering and Technology History Wiki · 2024-02-11
- Project MAC | MIT Museum

DEFENSE FUNDING REALITIES

96%  16 items · 11 domains

ARPA funded Project MAC through the Information Processing Techniques Office starting in the early 1960s. These defense grants aimed to expand military command and general time-sharing capabilities. Federal paper trails connected institutional academic research directly to Department of Defense budgets. This funding structure coincided with rising anti-war sentiment among Cambridge students.

- | DARPA
- Project MAC | DARPA
- Project MAC:
- Information Processing Techniques Office — Grokipedia · 2025-12-25
- Project MAC - darpa.mil
- IPTO | DARPA
- IPTO - Information Processing Techniques Office | LivingInternet · 2020-11-24
- Project MAC · 2014-08-14
- Vietnam War, 1961-1975 -- Protest movements | MIT ArchivesSpace
- Howard W. Johnson, President of M.I.T. During Vietnam War Protests, Dies at 88 - The New York Times · 2009-12-18
- MIT's Anti-War Protests 1967-1972 — Science and Revolution · 2019-03-24
- Slight Rebellion off Mass. Ave. | MIT Technology Review · 2024-08-22
- Science Action Coordinating Committee Papers | NMAH.AC.0473 | SOVA, Smithsonian Institution
- The Cold War and American Science; Chapter 9

PERIOD DIET EPHEMERA

96%  16 items · 13 domains

Late-night terminal sessions were sustained by coin-operated campus vending machines. Staff bought packaged cigarettes, cold sandwiches, and black coffee in paper cups. The Walker Memorial dining hall served institutional cafeteria food during standard shift hours. Empty paper containers and metal ashtrays piled up next to keypunch desks during overnight debugging runs.

- The History of Dining at MIT Michael Plasmeier 3/31/2010 · 2010-04-10
- Walker Memorial | Dining hall at MIT. | Jason Cook | Flickr · 2026-04-05
- Dining Locations - MIT Division of Student Life · 2026-04-02
- 6:30 to 10:30 a.m. 11 a.m. to 2 p.m. 11 a.m. to 7:30 p.m. 6:30 to 10:30 a.m. · 2026-08-12
- Rebecca's Café serves up new operating hours | MIT News | Massachusetts Institute of Technology
- Dining Options on Campus | The Tech · 2007-08-28
- MIT Campus Dining - MIT Division of Student Life · 2026-08-06
- New Episode of Coin-Op Corner -1960's Cigarette Vending Machine · 2023-03-28
- r/nostalgia on Reddit: Vintage Cigarette vending machine 1960's · 2021-05-21
- r/TheWayWeWere on Reddit: What vending machines looked like in the 60's · 2023-12-13
- Late 1960s cigarette machine available - MakerTrade · 2019-04-25
- Vintage cigarette vending machine · 2026-08-22
- Cigarette machine — Grokipedia · 2026-01-14
- Cigarette Vending - For Sale on 1stDibs

PSYCHOANALYTIC DIALECT EVOLUTION

96%  17 items · 15 domains

ELIZA's DOCTOR script adopted the non-directive conventions of Carl Rogers' client-centered therapy. Rogerian transcripts show an interviewer repeating statements back to clients to encourage self-reflection. Student hackers on campus used technical jargon shaped by early computer systems. The software mirrored user prompts using simple keyword replacement rather than real comprehension.

- (PDF) Carl Rogers in the Therapy Room: A listing of session transcripts and a survey of publications referring to Rogers' sessions / Carl Rogers im Therapieraum: Eine Auflistung von Sitzungstranskripten und ein Überblick über Publikationen, die sich auf Rogers' Therapiesitzungen beziehen / Carl Rogers ... | Germain Lietaer - Academia.edu · 2016-02-06
- (PDF) Carl Rogers in the Therapy Room: A listing of session transcripts and a survey of publications referring to Rogers' sessions / Carl Rogers im Therapieraum: Eine Auflistung von Sitzungstranskripten und ein Überblick über Publikationen, die sich auf Rogers' Therapiesitzungen beziehen / Carl Rogers en el Consultorio: Una lista de las sesiones transcriptas y un relevamiento de publicaciones referidas a las sesiones de Rogers / Carl Rogers in de therapiekamer: Lijst van sessietranscripten en overzicht · 1995-10-01
- Person-Centered Therapy (Rogerian Therapy) - StatPearls - NCBI Bookshelf · 2023-02-09
- Carl Rogers in the Therapy Room: A listing of session transcripts and a survey of publications referring to Rogers' sessions / Carl Rogers im Therapieraum: Eine Auflistung von Sitzungstranskripten und ein Überblick über Publikationen, die sich auf Rogers' Therapiesitzungen beziehen / Carl Rogers en el Consultorio: Una lista de las sesiones transcriptas y un relevamiento de publicaciones referidas a las sesiones de Rogers / Carl Rogers in de therapiekamer: Lijst van sessietranscripten en overzicht van publ · 2003-12-01
- Carl Rogers' Session Transcripts
- (PDF) An Analysis of How Carl Rogers Enacted Client-Centered Conversation With Gloria · 2001-04-01
- Transcripts of Carl Rogers' Therapy Sessions
- Microsoft Word - Final Miller From the Desert Celebrating Rogers · 2014-12-22
- The Original Hacker's Dictionary
- Jargon File - Wikipedia · 2026-06-30
- The MIT jargon file version 299
- On The Jargon File; A History of the Original Hacker Dictionary. | by BeMyApp | Medium · 2016-05-11
- The New Hacker's Dictionary (book) — Grokipedia · 2026-01-21
- Jargon File
- The Original Hacker's Dictionary

LABORATORY ACOUSTIC ENVIRONMENT

95%  36 items · 23 domains

Machine rooms produced a loud and continuous wall of industrial noise. Mainframe cooling equipment and air chillers ran at high power to keep transistor banks cool. Teletype printers hammered paper platens with sharp metallic clicks. Punch-card sorters added continuous mechanical vibrations across the raised computer-room floors.

- IBM 7090 - Wikipedia · 2026-08-10
- IBM 7090/7094 | National Museum of American History
- AN IBM 7090 MAINFRAME COMPUTER, INTERNATIONAL BUSINESS MACHINE CORPORATION, 1959 | Christie's
- IBM-7094
- IBM 709 - Wikipedia · 2026-03-26
- The IBM 7090
- The IBM 7090 is The First Computer to Sing
- The WRE IBM 7090/94 General
- Teletype Model 33 · 2026-08-23
- r/vintagecomputing on Reddit: Found an old 60s/70s Teletype asr33 at a flea market yesterday. Can anyone give me some info about the machine? · 2022-07-18
- Engineering:Teletype Model 33 - HandWiki · 2025-11-26
- A teletype machine (also called a teleprinter or TTY) is · 2026-07-23
- Teletype Model 33 - Wikipedia · 2026-06-06
- Teletype Model 33 ASR - curiousmarc.com
- ASR 33 Teletype - Department of Computer Science, University of York

TELETYPE INTERFACE PROTOCOLS · emergent

95%  18 items · 13 domains

Users conversed with ELIZA through Model 33 and Model 35 Teletype terminals. Operators pressed mechanical keys that required deliberate physical force. Characters printed onto continuous rolls of yellow paper at a fixed speed of ten

characters per second. The terminal paused between user input and machine replies as the remote time-sharing system processed text.

- Teletype Model 33 - Wikipedia · 2026-08-23
- ASR 33 Teletype Information
- ELIZA Archaeology - 2 Talking to ELIZA on an ASR 33 Teletype · 2024-03-15
- Teletype Model 33 — Grokipedia · 2026-01-17
- Model ASR33 Teletype - Trammell Hudson's Projects
- ASR 33 Documentation - Charles Baetsen's Hobby Page · 2023-10-24
- ASR-33 Teletype
- Teletype Model 33 - Alchetron, The Free Social Encyclopedia · 2026-04-25
- Eliza · 2026-08-06
- weizenbaum.eliza.1966.pdf
- Joseph Weizenbaum's ELIZA: Communications of the ACM, January 1966
- Chatbots Decoded - CHM · 2026-05-12
- ELIZA—a computer program for the study of natural language communication between man and machine | Communications of the ACM
- ELIZA - HandWiki · 2026-06-20
- ELIZA — Grokipedia · 2026-01-14

CAMBRIDGE STREET LIFE

95%  13 items · 10 domains

Massachusetts Avenue carried heavy commuter vehicle traffic and MBTA bus lines through Cambridge. The MBTA rapid transit system connected Harvard Square and Central Square directly to central Boston. Kiosks and local storefronts displayed daily newspapers and underground anti-war publications. Student anti-draft demonstrations gathered momentum along the main campus thoroughfares.

- Cambridge: Massachusetts Avenue. | Historic New England · 2025-03-21
- 650+ Cambridge Massachusetts Street Stock Photos, Pictures & Royalty-Free Images - iStock
- What's Doing in CAMBRIDGE, MASS. - The New York Times · 1976-08-22
- Image Collections - Cambridge Historical Commission - City of Cambridge, Massachusetts
- What's at the Heart of Central Square? | Magazine | The Harvard Crimson · 2026-04-10
- Maps | MBTA
- MBTA Rapid Transit Lines Map Master Sheet 1966 – Boston In Transit
- Getting Around Town: Four Centuries of Mapping Boston in Transit
- Historical MBTA Rapid Transit Map V2 – MBTAgifts
- Cambridge Public Transit Map the City of Cambridge (.gov) <https://www.cambridgema.gov › transportation> · 2024-01-22
- A Brief History of MBTA Transit Maps | The History of the T | MBTA
- MBTA - Massachusetts Bay Transportation Authority MBTA <https://www.mbta.com>
- Amazon.com: Historic Pictoric Map - Greater Boston Transit Maps, Boston MBTA System Route Map 1966 Railroad Cartography - Vintage Poster Art Reproduction - 24in x 18in: Posters & Prints

CAMPUS COUNTERCULTURE REACTION

95%  12 items · 12 domains

Boston area underground publications documented rising opposition to military conscription. Organizations such as the Boston Draft Resistance Group distributed materials across regional campuses. Students began protesting university participation in defense-sponsored research. Underground newspapers circulated anti-war commentary alongside countercultural political manifestos.

- Avatar (newspaper) - Wikipedia · 2025-10-05
- Alternative/Underground Newspapers - Boston - LocalWiki
- Avatar: Boston Draft Resistance Group
- H-Net Reviews
- Anti-Draft in Boston: Boston Draft Resistance Group a.k.a. BDRG (Newsr – Third World Newsreel
- AVATAR 19 Feb16 1968 Boston Underground Newspaper MEL LYMAN Antiwar Dope LSD | eBay
- Anti-war Activists Sentenced to Prison
- student unrest | MIT ArchivesSpace
- March 4, 1969 Scientists Strike for Peace: 50 Years Later
- 1,000 Stage a Peaceful Protest Against War Research at M.I.T. - The New York Times
- Archival Collections - March 4: Scientists, Students, and Society - LibGuides at MIT Libraries · 2017-02-22

- Vietnam War Era: Student Movements - General, 1966-1974 - OAC

COMPUTING HARDWARE INTERACTION

94%  16 items · 9 domains

The IBM 7094 mainframe and the Compatible Time-Sharing System allowed multiple users to share central computer resources through remote consoles. Transistorized circuitry filled large metal cabinets. Console manuals specified precise operating steps for running tasks on the shared system. Operators relied on glowing diagnostic lights and system printouts to monitor active execution.

- CTSS console users' manual | 102726309 | Computer History Museum
- The IBM 7094 and CTSS
- Compatible Time-Sharing System - Wikipedia · 2026-06-10
- The IBM 7094 · Time Reshared
- IBM 7090
- Full text of "ibm :: 7094 :: A22-6703-4 7094 PoO Oct66"
- PDP-8 Console Teletype Instructions
- The U of Iowa's DEC PDP-8 Tour
- tty (Unix) — Grokipedia · 2026-01-14
- Teletype Model 33 - Wikipedia · 2026-08-23
- Computer Systems G. Bell, S. H. Fuller, and D. Siewiorek, Editors

CONTRADICTIONS

Where two sources disagree. Similarity alone never decides this; each pair below was read and judged.

CONTRADICTS

Text A dates the upgrade from the IBM 7090 to the IBM 7094 to 1964. Text B dates the same upgrade to 1963. The two dates cannot both be right.

A — Project MAC · multicians.org · 2014-08-14

B — The IBM 7094 and CTSS · multicians.org

REFERENCE REEL

The strongest material, cut into a sequence a director can read.

00:00 Establishing MIT Campus

Wide shots introduce the mid-1960s MIT campus layout, architectural landmarks, and the academic setting of Building 26.

- MIT Facilities - Maps & Floor Plans · web.mit.edu
- MIT Building 26 | Flickr · [flickr.com](https://www.flickr.com/photos/mitbuilding26/) · 2025-09-12
- Home - MIT Buildings - LibGuides at MIT Libraries · libguides.mit.edu · 2008-08-12
- The Archeology of Building 26 | alum.mit.edu
- 5,747 Mit Building Stock Photos, High-Res Pictures, and Images - Getty Images · [gettyimages.com](https://www.gettyimages.com)
- Campus of the Massachusetts Institute of Technology - Wikipedia · en.wikipedia.org · 2026-07-10

00:15 Technology Square Offices

The camera moves off the main campus toward 545 Technology Square, the modern urban complex housing early computer science labs.

- MIT leaves behind a rich history in Tech Square | MIT News | Massachusetts Institute of Technology · news.mit.edu · 2004-03-17
- Tech Square · multicians.org
- Technology Square (Cambridge, Massachusetts) — Grokipedia · grokipedia.com · 2026-01-07
- Technology Square (Cambridge, Massachusetts) - Wikipedia · en.wikipedia.org · 2025-12-11
- 545-technology-square-93 - Philip Greenspun · philip.greenspun.com
- Project MAC: · tebatt.net

00:30 Project MAC Lab

We enter Project MAC's DARPA-funded research environment bustling with students, faculty, and institutional computing initiatives.

- Project MAC · multicians.org · 2014-08-14
- | DARPA · darpa.mil
- Project MAC | DARPA · darpa.mil
- Project MAC: · tebatt.net
- Information Processing Techniques Office — Grokipedia · grokipedia.com · 2025-12-25
- Students and Alumni - MIT People - LibGuides at MIT Libraries · libguides.mit.edu · 2019-04-22

00:45 Mainframes and Terminals

Close-up textures focus on the humming IBM mainframes, manual consoles, and the Compatible Time-Sharing System interface powering the lab.

- CTSS console users' manual | 102726309 | Computer History Museum · computerhistory.org
- The IBM 7094 and CTSS · multicians.org
- AN IBM 7090 MAINFRAME COMPUTER, INTERNATIONAL BUSINESS MACHINE CORPORATION, 1959 | Christie's · [christies.com](https://www.christies.com)

01:00 The ELIZA Encounter

An intimate human-machine interaction unfolds as Rogerian psychotherapeutic dialogue is tested on console screens with Weizenbaum's secretary.

- Person-Centered Therapy (Rogerian Therapy) - StatPearls - NCBI Bookshelf · [ncbi.nlm.nih.gov](https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov) · 2023-02-09
- ELIZA Archaeology - 3 Weizenbaum's Secretary · sites.google.com

DEPARTMENTS

The same boxes, grouped by which crew briefs off them, with what each one actually contains.

Script

DEFENSE FUNDING REALITIES · 16 items

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SECRETARIAL EMOTIONAL ATTACHMENT · 18 items

Weizenbaum's secretary conducted early test conversations using the ELIZA DOCTOR script. She quickly began treating the terminal as a private diary for personal secrets. She asked Weizenbaum to leave the room so she could confide in the machine alone. Her reaction terrified Weizenbaum, who had assumed users would recognize the software as a simple trick.

CAMPUS COUNTERCULTURE REACTION · 12 items

Boston area underground publications documented rising opposition to military conscription. Organizations such as the Boston Draft Resistance Group distributed materials across regional campuses. Students began protesting university participation in defense-sponsored research. Underground newspapers circulated anti-war commentary alongside countercultural political manifestos.

TELETYPE INTERFACE PROTOCOLS · 18 items

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Casting

ACADEMIC CASTE ATTIRE · 27 items

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Costume

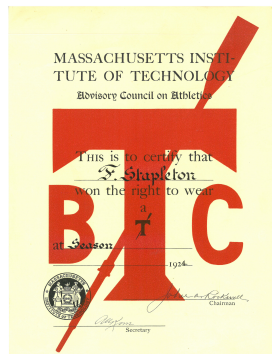
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Art direction

COMPUTING HARDWARE INTERACTION · 16 items

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CAMPUS COUNTERCULTURE REACTION · 12 items

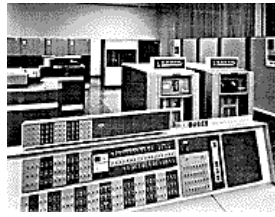
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Sound

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Cinematography

COMPUTING HARDWARE INTERACTION · 16 items

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Locations

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PRIOR ART

40 existing films surveyed for a similar premise, seeded from: artificial intelligence, mit, 1960s, scientist, computer pioneer, ethics.

MIT: Regressions (2022)

institutional memory compiled as a shipped archival feature · bystander · reflective · observing technological shifts without personal accountability · historical panorama left open

similarity 0.62 · <https://www.themoviedb.org/movie/986769>

To Go to the Moon (2022)

nascent computational precision used as an intended feature · investigator · earnest · proving individual worth through technical dedication · professional breakthrough achieved

similarity 0.60 · <https://www.themoviedb.org/movie/1571887>

Love Insurance Kompany (2026)

algorithmic matchmaking subverted by an internal conceptual flaw · perpetrator · satirical · awakening from corporate complicity to human empathy · subversive self-correction of the system

similarity 0.57 · <https://www.themoviedb.org/movie/1209511>

The InTEXTigator (2020)

forensic pattern matching deployed as a shipped feature · investigator · procedural · relying on automation to validate human justice · crime solved by machine logic

similarity 0.57 · <https://www.themoviedb.org/movie/1749484>

Kissing Is the Easy Part (2026)

academic status competition manipulated as a systemic flaw · perpetrator · romantic · abandoning institutional ambition for emotional honesty · romantic reconciliation over academic success

similarity 0.56 · <https://www.themoviedb.org/movie/1515615>

The InTEXTigator 3: The Line of the Four (2022)

deductive automated analysis deployed as a shipped feature · investigator · procedural · formalizing human intuition into algorithmic certainty · stolen property recovered

similarity 0.56 · <https://www.themoviedb.org/movie/1749395>

The InTEXTigator 2: A Study in Samples (2020)

predictive surveillance logic acting as an intended feature · investigator · procedural · subordinating investigative instinct to synthetic forecast · threat averted before execution

similarity 0.55 · <https://www.themoviedb.org/movie/1749469>

HappyDeal (2026)

corporate algorithmic labor extraction weaponized as a feature · victim · bleak · surrendering dignity to survive an economic trap · entrapment within corporate employment

similarity 0.54 · <https://www.themoviedb.org/movie/1735559>

The Tunnel (2025)

particle mind-manifestation malfunctioning as a fatal flaw · investigator · dread · discovering intellectual hubris produces physical terror · existential containment failure

similarity 0.54 · <https://www.themoviedb.org/movie/1746868>

Zoe (2018)

synthetic relationship design destabilized by an emergent flaw · investigator · melancholic · questioning whether engineered affection replaces genuine connection · fragile acceptance of synthetic emotion

similarity 0.53 · <https://www.themoviedb.org/movie/458005>

Calder (1966)

structural physical engineering displayed as a shipped feature · bystander · observational · documenting artistic materialization within an academic space · monument successfully erected

similarity 0.53 · <https://www.themoviedb.org/movie/1369626>

Muito Prazer (2026)

inherited architectural neglect operating as a persistent flaw · victim · drab · accepting modest communal solidarity amid material ruin · tenuous coexistence in decay

similarity 0.52 · <https://www.themoviedb.org/movie/1249562>

Where this stands, and where it does not yet

Originality is claimed only relative to the titles above, never absolutely.

A horror-tinged tragedy told from the perspective of an inventor horrified by users treating a simple script as a sentient confidant.

None of the listed films feature a creator whose moral arc ends in absolute renunciation of their own working invention.

checked against: To Go to the Moon, Zoe, Love Insurance Kompany, MIT: Regressions

→ Center the narrative on Weizenbaum's mounting terror as his secretary and students demand private time with ELIZA, treating parodic string manipulation as divine empathy.

A psychological drama centering on a vulnerable human test subject who becomes a victim of linguistic projection.

The existing fictional AI films frame the machine as an effective investigator, a romantic companion, or a physical anomaly.

checked against: The InTEXTigator, The InTEXTigator 2: A Study in Samples, The InTEXTigator 3: The Line of the Four, Zoe

→ Adopt the perspective of an isolated MIT typist in 1966 who experiences genuine psychological destabilization by mistaking ELIZA's programmed Rogerian echoes for deep human recognition.

A cold institutional tragedy about academic bureaucracy co-opting a trivial computational parlor trick into a weapon of psychiatric efficiency.

The institutional films listed treat the university as a neutral backdrop or a vehicle for hopeful engineering triumph.

checked against: Calder, Kissing Is the Easy Part, MIT: Regressions, To Go to the Moon

→ Depict MIT administrators and military liaisons attempting to strip-mine Weizenbaum's rudimentary script to automate mental health triage for Vietnam-bound recruits despite his protests.

RESEARCH LOG

What each pass searched, found, and did next. Process detail, not required reading.

PASS 000

145 sources · 161 fragments · 40 via Extract

coverage 0% → 92% confidence 0% → 78%

COMPUTING HARDWARE INTERACTION — IBM 7094 console lights operating manual Project MAC CTSS audio recording 1966; DEC PDP-6 teletype paper tape handling CTSS terminal interface operational mechanics

INSTITUTIONAL ARCHITECTURE TEXTURE — MIT Building 26 interior floor plan lighting 1960s architectural photographs; 545 Technology Square MIT Project MAC office layout interior finishes mid 1960s

DEFENSE FUNDING REALITIES — DARPA IPTO Project MAC grant contracts correspondence 1965 1966 MIT defense funding; MIT administration defense research contracts Vietnam War protests financial records 1966

ACADEMIC CASTE ATTIRE — MIT student faculty programmer dress code 1966 photographic archives The Tech yearbook; 1966 MIT Tech Model Railroad Club hackers secretaries clothing grooming Cambridge Massachusetts

PSYCHOANALYTIC DIALECT EVOLUTION — Carl Rogers non-directive client-centered therapy session transcript audio 1960s; MIT hacker jargon dictionary AI Lab 1966 computer speech argot

SECRETARIAL EMOTIONAL ATTACHMENT — Joseph Weizenbaum ELIZA secretary reaction oral history interviews 1966; MIT Project MAC female administrative staff keypunch operators diaries interviews 1960s

CAMBRIDGE STREET LIFE — Cambridge Massachusetts Avenue coffee shops newsstands street photography 1966; MBTA transit map Cambridge anti-war student demonstrations Boston 1966

LABORATORY ACOUSTIC ENVIRONMENT — IBM 7090 7094 computer room chiller cooling noise sound recording archival; Teletype Model 33 ASR IBM 026 card punch machine operational sound acoustics

CAMPUS COUNTERCULTURE REACTION — Boston Avatar underground newspaper 1966 anti-war campus draft resistance MIT; MIT student anti-war mobilization military research strike leaflet archives 1966

PERIOD DIET EPHEMERA — MIT Walker Memorial cafeteria menu institutional food late night coffee 1960s; 1960s vending machines Cambridge cigarette brands tech computer lab night shift ephemera

→ investigate LABORATORY ACOUSTIC ENVIRONMENT (score 0.63)

PASS 001

43 sources · 47 fragments · 12 via Extract

coverage 92% → 96% confidence 78% → 80%

opened: TELETYPE INTERFACE PROTOCOLS

ACADEMIC CASTE ATTIRE — MIT Project MAC computer lab staff photographs 1966 clothing hair styles; MIT artificial intelligence laboratory student programmer attire 1960s archive photos

LABORATORY ACOUSTIC ENVIRONMENT — MIT Building 26 computation center IBM 7094 machine room noise cooling acoustic environment; 1960s mainframe computer room audio recording punch card sorter fan soundscape

TELETYPE INTERFACE PROTOCOLS — Teletype Model 33 ASR typing sound speed baud rate Project MAC time-sharing; Joseph Weizenbaum ELIZA user interaction Teletype terminal paper printout speed latency

→ investigate COMPUTING HARDWARE INTERACTION (score 0.94)